

Strengthening and toning exercises

Exercises that strengthen your muscles will help you deal with the additional demands of pregnancy and to manage better during labor and birth.

The exercises shown are sometimes called “functional movement enhancers” because they increase the strength of the muscles that you use for everyday functions such as walking, carrying, lifting, sitting, and standing. The workout can be used alongside walking, swimming, or other cardiovascular exercises and should be done three to four times a week.

Warm up Walk in place, swinging your arms back and forth. Continue for 3–5 minutes until your muscles are warm.